

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title A Double-blind, Placebo-controlled Phase IIa Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of AZD7798 in Patients with Moderate to Severe Crohn's Disease [AMALTHEA] **Short Title/ Acronym** AMALTHEA Study **Protocol Number** D9690C00005 **NCT Number** NCT06450197 **Sponsor Name** AstraZeneca **Investigational Product** AZD7798 (humanised monoclonal antibody) **Phase of Development** Phase IIa **Medical Monitor** AstraZeneca Clinical Operations Lead

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective * **Primary Objective:** To evaluate the efficacy of AZD7798 compared to placebo by assessing the remission of the Crohn's Disease Activity Index (CDAI) at Week 12. * **Secondary Objectives:** To evaluate endoscopic response, endoscopic remission, endoscopic score change from baseline (SES-CD), CDAI response, CDAI score change from baseline, symptomatic remission, pharmacokinetic (PK) parameters, and anti-drug antibody (ADA) responses.

2.2 Background & Rationale Crohn's disease (CD) is a chronic inflammatory bowel disease affecting the digestive tract. Many patients with CD do not respond adequately to current treatments (including conventional therapies, biologics, or JAK inhibitors), experience adverse side effects, or lose response over time. To address this therapeutic gap, this study investigates AZD7798, a novel drug targeting specific immune cell pathways in the gut, to potentially reduce inflammation more effectively and provide a new option for patients with moderate to severe CD.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework * **Study Type:** Interventional * **Control Type:** Placebo-controlled * **Blinding:** Double-blind * **Randomization:** Randomized, Parallel group

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration * **Target \$N\$:** Approximately 107 to 192 evaluable patients * **Number of Sites:** Global Multicenter * **Estimated Study Start:** 2024 * **Estimated Primary Completion:** May 2027

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. 18 to 80 years of age. 2. Diagnosis of Crohn's disease established with verifiable clinical, AND at least one of imaging, endoscopic and/or histopathologic evidence, with moderate to severe active disease. 3. A history of at least one of: Intolerance or inadequate response to conventional

treatment (oral corticosteroid, azathioprine, 6-mercaptopurine, or methotrexate), biologics, or other approved advanced therapy (e.g., JAK inhibitors), OR corticosteroid dependency.

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Evidence, or clinical suspicion, of other forms of IBD or concomitant additional active gastrointestinal luminal inflammatory diseases. 2. Current significant major or unstable respiratory disease, heart disease, cerebrovascular disease, haematological disease, hepatic disease, renal disease, gastrointestinal disease (other than active CD), or prolonged QTcF interval. 3. Any complications of Crohn's disease where surgery is anticipated or planned prior to the end of study treatment, or evidence of extensive prior gastrointestinal surgical interventions.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen * **Dosage/Frequency:** AZD7798 or matching placebo administered once every 4 weeks (Q4W). * **Route of Administration:** Subcutaneous (SC) injection. * **Duration of Treatment:** 12 weeks of double-blind treatment, followed by a 36-week safety and monitoring follow-up period.

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy * **Permitted:** Stable doses of baseline treatments as defined per protocol. * **Prohibited:** Systemic steroids > 20 mg/day (or prednisolone equivalent), immunomodulators within 4 weeks of screening, antibiotic therapy for the treatment of Crohn's disease, probiotics within 2 weeks, chronic use of NSAIDs, and any investigational drug within 4 months prior to screening endoscopy.

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures
Screening	Weeks -4 to 0	Informed Consent, Medical History, Endoscopy, TB/Infection Screening
Baseline	Day 0	Randomization, First Dose (AZD7798/Placebo), CDAI Assessment
Interim	Weeks 4, 8	Subcutaneous Dosing, Safety Labs, Efficacy/Symptom Assessment
End of Treatment	Week 12	Primary Efficacy Assessment (CDAI remission), Endoscopy (SES-CD)
End of Study	Up to Week 48	Final Safety Follow-up, PK/ADA monitoring, Exit Interview

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint * **Definition:** Crohn's Disease Activity Index (CDAI) remission at Week 12. * **Measurement Method:** Clinical assessment and standardized CDAI scoring system.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints * Endoscopic response and endoscopic remission as measured by SES-CD change from baseline. * CDAI response and CDAI score change from baseline. *

Symptomatic remission, Pharmacokinetic (PK) parameters, and Anti-Drug Antibodies (ADA).

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

- **Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring:** Continuous monitoring through patient visits, vital signs, physical examinations, and clinical laboratory testing.
- **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** Standard reporting timeline (typically 24 hours of site awareness).
- **Data Monitoring Committee (DMC):** External independent committee to evaluate ongoing safety and tolerability.

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

- **Analysis Populations:** Intent-to-Treat (ITT) for primary efficacy; Safety Set for all participants receiving at least one dose of study medication.
- **Sample Size Justification:** Powered to detect a statistically significant difference in the proportion of patients achieving CDAI remission at Week 12 between the AZD7798 and placebo arms.
- **Handling of Missing Data:** Non-responder imputation (NRI) for binary categorical endpoints and Mixed-Effect Model Repeat Treatment (MMRM) for continuous data over time.

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

- **GCP Compliance:** This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki.
- **Monitoring Plan:** Regular onsite and remote monitoring visits to ensure data integrity and protocol compliance.
- **Audit Trail:** Centralized reading for endoscopic evaluations (SES-CD) to ensure unbiased, standardized scoring; full eCRF locking and data clarification mechanisms.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

- **Primary ID:** {{D9690C00005}}
- **Registry Number:** {{NCT06450197}}
- **Sponsor/Lead Organization:** {{AstraZeneca}}
- **Study Title:** {{AMALTHEA}}
- **Official Regulatory Title:** {{A Double-blind, Placebo-controlled Phase IIa Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of AZD7798 in Patients With Moderate to Severe Crohn's Disease}}

12. Clinical Framework (Crohn's Disease Specific)

- **Primary Condition:** {{Moderate to severe Crohn's disease}}

- **Diagnosis Threshold:** {{Verifiable clinical + imaging/ endoscopic/histopathologic evidence}}
- **Medical Methodology:** {{Targeted biologic therapy / Monoclonal Antibody (AZD7798)}}
- **Optimization Target:** {{CDAI remission and mucosal healing at Week 12}}

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

- **Management Pathway:** {{Double-blind, placebo-controlled experimental pathway}}
- **Education Protocol (HCP):** {{Investigator training on standard CDAI scoring and centralized endoscopy guidelines}}
- **Education Protocol (Patient):** {{Trial procedure familiarization and electronic symptom diary reporting}}
- **Quality Audit Mechanism:** {{Centralized blinded reading of endoscopy videos to confirm eligibility and SES-CD endpoints}}

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

- **Total Duration:** {{48 weeks (12-week treatment period + 36-week follow-up period)}}
- **Onsite Visit Cadence:** {{Screening, Baseline, Week 4, Week 8, Week 12, and structured safety follow-ups}}
- **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** {{Standard interval checks per protocol}}
- **Checklist Review Interval:** {{Continuous evaluation via patient-reported outcomes for symptomatic remission}}

15. Sign-off & Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date		---	---	---	---
Principal Investigator	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]					
Clinical Operations Lead	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]					
Lead Statistician	[Insert Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]					